Bharat Jodo Yatra: An Attempt at Harmonizing the Country

D. Raja

When the Indian republic inaugurated itself on 26 January 1950, it was a major historic transformation in our nation's journey towards the emancipation of our impoverished and suppressed masses. After freeing itself from colonial clutches, India embarked on a journey of building a society that our freedom fighters sacrificed their lives for. Our freedom movement's message of inclusivity in various streams of thought and action, the Congress-led movement, revolutionaries, communists, socialists and social reformers were united to free India from the British and to give our people a better future. That shared future was to build on the premise of liberty, equality, fraternity and justice as enshrined in the Preamble of our Constitution. The enactment of the Constitution of India was a great achievement as it established political equality among the differently situated citizens of our vast country and placed safeguards for the vulnerable sections of society. The Constitution also placed a great task before the nation, that is to graduate to social and economic equality on the foundations of political equality.

Ironically, our country is witnessing a retreat from the promises of our Constitution. Over the past nine years, the RSS-controlled BJP government has insidiously misused the electoral process,[1] the media, the public institutions and the investigative agencies[2] to promote its divisive ideology. It has especially targeted the Opposition[3] to promote one-party rule, which exclusively works for the RSS and its agenda. That is why almost every Opposition leader has faced false raids, attempts to tarnish their image and